

PURPOSE & PATTERNS

Simulate residential location choice and developer conversion on a parcel grid to evaluate the effect of zoning, urban-growth boundaries and transit-oriented development on urban-sprawl patterns; engine of a regional planning Digital Twin.

DATA INPUTS

Parcel Cadastre

STATIC

County GIS: parcel boundaries, ownership, current use
-> *Initialize the spatial grid & developable mask*

Census Demographics

STATIC

Tract-level household composition, income, tenure
-> *Population synthesis & preference-class assignment*

Historical Land-Use Maps

DYNAMIC

NLCD / Landsat-derived developed-vs-undeveloped, decadal
-> *Calibration target & validation reference*

Real-Estate Transactions

DYNAMIC

Recent sale prices, hedonic attributes, move histories
-> *Hedonic regression for amenity weights; preference clustering*

Zoning & Policy Layers

DYNAMIC

Zoning, growth boundaries, transit corridors, road network
-> *Constrain feasible parcels & accessibility scoring*

DATA PIPELINE

1. Collection

County GIS download | USGS NLCD / Landsat archive | Census microdata | MLS / assessor transaction feed

2. Pre-processing

Parcel-to-raster rasterization (100 m) | Land-cover reclassification (developed / undeveloped) | Spatial join of demographics to parcels

3. Analysis

Hedonic regression for amenity weights | k-means clustering of move patterns -> preference classes | Accessibility surface (network distance to CBD & transit)

ABM CORE: ResLUCC (Residential Land-Use Change ABM)

AGENTS (n=[N = households + developers])

Types: Household, Developer

State variables:

- income
- preference_class
- tenure_status
- current_parcel
- dissatisfaction

-> *Census Demographics + Real-Estate*

Submodels (Behaviors)

Move Decision

Triggered by life-cycle events or dissatisfaction threshold

Location Choice

Utility-based bid over feasible parcels (multinomial logit)

Developer Conversion

Convert undeveloped -> developed if expected return > threshold

Amenity Update

Neighbor density & land cover update local aesthetic score

ENVIRONMENT

Grid: Regular raster of parcels
Resolution: 100 m x 100 m cells
Layers: Zoning, Accessibility, Amenity, Existing development

-> *Parcel Cadastre; Historical Land-Use Maps*

INTERACTIONS

* Agent <> Agent

Households bid competitively for the same parcel; highest bid wins (auction mechanism)

Neighbor effects: nearby development alters local aesthetic & price

* Agent <> Env

Zoning rules constrain the feasible-parcel set
Accessibility (distance to CBD / transit) enters utility

* Topology

Regular 2D raster of parcels
Moore neighborhood for local effects

-> *Zoning & Policy Layers; Real-Estate Transactions*

Temporal: 1 year | Duration: 40 years (1990-2030)

Stop: Simulation horizon reached OR developable land exhausted

OBSERVATIONS

[#] Settlement Pattern Map

Predicted developed / undeveloped raster vs observed
Spatial map
Emergent: Leapfrog development & fragmented edges

[~] Density Gradient

Built-up density vs distance to CBD over time
Curve
Emergent: Monocentric -> polycentric structure under TOD scenarios

MODEL EVALUATION

Calibration

Method: Pattern-oriented modeling (POM) with genetic algorithm

Params: preference weights, developer threshold, neighbor-effect radius

Data: Historical Land-Use Maps (1990 -> 2010 trajectory)

Result: Best-fit parameter set; Kappa > 0.70 on calibration period

Validation

- Multi-resolution Kappa on held-out 2010-2020 maps
- Density-gradient & fractal-dimension comparison
- Null-model contrast (random allocation, persistence)

Result: Pattern metrics within 10% of observed; null clearly rejected

SCENARIOS (if applicable):

Baseline

Status-quo zoning; calibrated preferences

Growth Boundary

Strict urban-growth boundary around existing built-up area

TOD Upzoning

Higher allowed density within 800 m of transit corridors

★ Combined

Growth boundary + TOD upzoning; key DT policy scenario